

STAGE NINE • ENGLISH VOCABULARY FIRST SET

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Six sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 38 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Nine • English Vocabulary First Set

OVERVIEW

Stage Nine's thirty-eight FIRSTS are split across six sessions, one per section, matching the Manual's existing structure. Unlike most other stages, this one is vocabulary instruction, not reflection or action exercises — sessions should feel more like an active language class than a workshop: short input, immediate output, real-time correction.

Every session in this stage should include genuine spoken or written production, not just reading through word lists. Build in pair practice, mini-drills, or quick writing prompts throughout rather than saving all production for the end.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Core Vocabulary Building Blocks — M1-M10	~140 min
Session 2	Written & Documentation Vocabulary — M11-M15	~85 min
Session 3	Meeting & Verbal Communication Vocabulary — M16-M25, M38	~120 min
Session 4	Presentation & Persuasion Vocabulary — M26-M31	~95 min
Session 5	Self-Presentation & Networking Vocabulary — M19-M21, M32	~65 min
Session 6	Problem-Solving & Growth Vocabulary — M33-M37	~80 min

SESSION 1

Core Vocabulary Building Blocks

Covers FIRSTS M1-M10: 20 Professional Adjectives, 20 Action Verbs, 10 Transition Words, 10 Academic Phrases, 20 Workplace Phrases, 10 Presentation Words, 10 Networking Words, 10 Polite Expressions, 10 Idioms, Vocabulary Reflection.

PRE-WORK

- No advance preparation required. This is the entry point to the whole stage — no prior vocabulary knowledge assumed.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: active use, not passive recognition, is the goal all stage long	Full group
0:10-0:30	FIRST M1 — 20 Professional Adjectives: study 5 at a time + sentence practice	Solo, then pairs share
0:30-0:50	FIRST M2 — 20 Action Verbs: rewrite a real resume bullet	Solo

0:50–1:05	FIRST M3 — 10 Transition Words: classification drill	Solo, then group check
1:05–1:20	FIRST M4 — 10 Academic Phrases: structure a short paragraph	Solo
1:20–1:25	Short break	—
1:25–1:45	FIRST M5 — 20 Workplace Phrases: natural vs. template discussion	Full group
1:45–2:00	FIRST M6 — 10 Presentation Words: replace filler with precise language	Solo
2:00–2:15	FIRST M7 — 10 Networking Words: mock introduction practice	Pairs
2:15–2:30	FIRST M8 — 10 Polite Expressions: calibration across 3 scenarios	Solo
2:30–2:45	FIRST M9 — 10 Idioms: comprehension check + cross-cultural discussion	Full group
2:45–3:05	FIRST M10 — Vocabulary Reflection: 5 genuine sentences + session close	Solo

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This is the longest session in the stage by a wide margin — strongly consider splitting it across two sittings rather than running three-plus hours in one block.
- If split, a natural break point is after M5, since M1–M5 form a coherent writing-focused half and M6–M10 shift toward spoken and reflective practice.
- Build genuine spoken practice into M7 specifically; this list doesn't transfer well from silent reading alone.

SESSION 2

Written & Documentation Vocabulary

Covers FIRSTS M11–M15: Professional Email Vocabulary, Report & Memo Vocabulary, Agenda/Minutes Vocabulary, Vocabulary for Documenting Decisions, Vocabulary for Summarizing Findings.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring a real email, report, or set of meeting notes they've written, to use as practice material throughout this session.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: this session is entirely written, formal register	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST M11 — Professional Email Vocabulary: rewrite a real email	Solo
0:30–0:45	FIRST M12 — Report & Memo Vocabulary: label a sample report	Solo
0:45–1:00	FIRST M13 — Agenda/Minutes Vocabulary: decision vs. action vs. discussion drill	Solo, then group check
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:20	FIRST M14 — Documenting Decisions: finality-calibration practice	Solo
1:20–1:25	FIRST M15 — Summarizing Findings + session close	Solo

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session is the shortest and most purely written of the whole stage — a good candidate to run as a quieter, more independent working session.
- M13 and M14 are closely related; if time is tight, they can be taught together as one extended block rather than two fully separate segments.

SESSION 3

Meeting & Verbal Communication Vocabulary

Covers *FIRSTS M16, M17, M22, M18, M23–M25, M38: Meeting/Call Vocabulary, Negotiation & Persuasion Vocabulary, Follow-Up Vocabulary, Feedback Vocabulary, Follow-Up After Networking, Question-Asking Vocabulary, Listening & Responding Vocabulary, Constructive Feedback (Advanced)*.

PRE-WORK

- This session is entirely spoken practice — no special preparation, but let participants know they'll be talking in pairs and small groups for most of the session.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is entirely live, spoken vocabulary	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST M16 — Meeting/Call Vocabulary: entry-phrase practice	Pairs
0:25–0:45	FIRST M17 — Negotiation & Persuasion: mock exchange	Pairs
0:45–1:00	FIRST M22 — Follow-Up Vocabulary: draft + read aloud	Solo, then pairs
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:25	FIRST M18 — Feedback Vocabulary: deliver one piece of feedback	Pairs
1:25–1:40	FIRST M23 — Follow-Up After Networking: draft with a specific detail	Solo
1:40–1:55	FIRST M24 — Question-Asking Vocabulary: closed-to-open rewrite drill	Solo, then pairs
1:55–2:10	FIRST M25 — Listening & Responding: paraphrase practice	Pairs
2:10–2:30	FIRST M38 — Advanced Constructive Feedback + session close	Pairs, then full-group debrief

FACILITATOR NOTES

- Note the section's real order: M16, M17, M22, M18, M23, M24, M25, M38 — not numerically sequential. This matches the Manual's own organization; don't “correct” the order back to numeric.
- This is a genuinely long, pair-work-heavy session; rotate pairs at least once partway through so practice isn't limited to a single partner's speaking style.
- M38 closes the session at a genuinely higher difficulty level than M18 — don't rush it if earlier segments ran long.

SESSION 4

Presentation & Persuasion Vocabulary

Covers FIRSTS M26–M31: Presentation Introduction Vocabulary, Vocabulary for Structuring Presentations, Vocabulary for Emphasizing Key Points, Audience Engagement Vocabulary, Q&A Handling Vocabulary, Persuasive Speaking Vocabulary.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring a short (2–3 minute) presentation topic they could speak on with minimal prep, real or improvised.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today builds a full presentation's vocabulary, opening to close	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST M26 — Presentation Introduction: deliver an opener	Solo, then pairs
0:25–0:40	FIRST M27 — Structuring Presentations: add verbal signposting	Solo
0:40–0:55	FIRST M28 — Emphasizing Key Points: single-point emphasis practice	Solo
0:55–1:00	Short break	—
1:00–1:15	FIRST M29 — Audience Engagement: engagement question + genuine pause	Pairs
1:15–1:35	FIRST M30 — Q&A Handling: graceful non-answer role-play	Pairs
1:35–1:50	FIRST M31 — Persuasive Speaking: close with an explicit ask + session close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This session works well as a build-up: by the end, participants should be able to chain M26 through M31 into one coherent, short presentation using this session's vocabulary throughout.
- If time allows, close with a few volunteers delivering a genuinely complete 90-second presentation start to finish, using language from across the whole session.

SESSION 5

Self-Presentation & Networking Vocabulary

Covers *FIRSTS M19–M21, M32: Professional Greeting Vocabulary, Self-Introduction Vocabulary, Small Talk Vocabulary, Workplace Expression Vocabulary*.

PRE-WORK

- No special preparation required. This is the shortest session in the stage.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is the vocabulary of a first impression	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST M19 — Professional Greeting: calibration across 3 contexts	Solo
0:25–0:40	FIRST M20 — Self-Introduction: hedge-free delivery practice	Pairs
0:40–0:55	FIRST M21 — Small Talk: 60-second exchange practice	Pairs
0:55–1:05	FIRST M32 — Workplace Expression Vocabulary + session close	Solo

FACILITATOR NOTES

- Given the short length, this session pairs naturally with Session 2 (also relatively short) if you need to consolidate the stage into fewer total sittings.
- M19–M21 build directly on each other (greeting → introduction → small talk) and work well taught as one continuous simulated encounter rather than three separate drills.

SESSION 6

Problem-Solving & Growth Vocabulary

Covers FIRSTS M33–M37: Vocabulary for Articulating Challenges, Vocabulary for Proposing Solutions, Vocabulary for Analyzing Pros and Cons, Vocabulary for Brainstorming, Vocabulary for Reflecting on Personal Growth.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to bring to mind one real, current challenge (work, school, or personal) they'd be comfortable discussing at a high level.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today's vocabulary takes a problem from naming it to learning from it	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST M33 — Articulating Challenges: vague-to-specific rewrite	Solo
0:25–0:40	FIRST M34 — Proposing Solutions: two genuine alternatives	Solo
0:40–0:55	FIRST M35 — Analyzing Pros and Cons: honest trade-off practice	Solo
0:55–1:00	Short break	—
1:00–1:20	FIRST M36 — Brainstorming Vocabulary: 2-minute generative-only round	Small groups
1:20–1:40	FIRST M37 — Reflecting on Growth: growth statement + example + stage close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- M33 through M36 form a natural real sequence (name the problem, propose solutions, weigh them, generate more options) — consider running them against one single real example chosen at the start, rather than four disconnected drills.
- M37 closes the entire stage; the reflection prompt works well pointed at the whole vocabulary-building experience itself, not just an unrelated topic.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Ten (Relationships & Connections), which draws directly on the communication vocabulary built throughout this entire stage.